WeForming

Middleware
User Manual

CONSORTIUM PARTNERS

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Executive Summary

This User Manual provides a comprehensive overview of the WeForming platform, guiding users through its core functionalities, concepts, and workflows within the WeForming data-sharing ecosystem. The platform is designed to support secure, transparent, and interoperable data exchanges among a diverse set of participants, including building owners, energy communities, service providers, and other stakeholders in the energy domain.

The manual introduces users to the main areas of the application, starting from the dashboard and navigation structure, and progressively covering key functionalities such as managing offerings, providing and consuming data, handling subscription requests, monitoring data exchange activities, and configuring connector settings. Special emphasis is placed on explaining how users can share their data (e.g., energy production or consumption measurements), discover available services, and participate in data-driven collaborations within the ecosystem.

Recognising that not all users are familiar with data space concepts or technical terminology, the manual adopts a clear and user-oriented approach. Core concepts such as data, connectors, offerings, APIs, and subscriptions are explained in a practical context, helping users understand not only what these elements are, but also how they relate to real-world use cases, such as energy communities, smart buildings, or renewable energy integration.

In addition, the manual describes supporting features that enhance usability and transparency, including notifications, timelines of data exchanges, filtering and search mechanisms, and access to useful documentation such as the iGFB-pedia, the User Manual itself, and deployment guides. The iGFB-pedia is highlighted as a complementary knowledge space, offering simplified explanations, examples, and demonstrations aimed at raising awareness and understanding beyond purely technical audiences.

Overall, this User Manual serves as both a practical guide for day-to-day use of the WeForming platform and an entry point into the broader WeForming ecosystem. Its goal is to empower users to confidently navigate the platform, manage their data and services, and actively participate in a trusted, interoperable, and user-centric energy data space.

1 Introduction & Getting Started

1.1 Understanding the Ecosystem and Its Core Concepts

The WeForming platform operates as a digital ecosystem that enables the secure exchange and use of data among different participants, including individual users, organizations, and service providers. Its primary goal is to make data sharing understandable, controlled, and beneficial, even for users who are not familiar with technical terminology or complex data infrastructures.

Within this ecosystem, data is treated as a valuable resource that can be shared, combined, and reused to create new services, improve decision-making, and support collaboration across different domains, with a strong focus on energy-related use cases.

1.2 What Is Data in This Context

In the context of the WeForming platform, data represents real-world information produced by systems, devices, or applications. Typical examples include energy production measurements from photovoltaic (PV) systems, energy consumption data from buildings or facilities, historical performance data, or aggregated energy indicators.

These datasets describe how energy is produced, consumed, or managed over time. By making such data available within the ecosystem, users can gain insights into their energy behavior, compare alternatives, or enable third parties to offer optimized and personalized services.

1.3 Providing Data

Providing data refers to the act of making specific datasets available to the ecosystem. When a user provides data, they are not giving up ownership of it; instead, they are allowing selected participants to access and use the data under defined conditions.

For example, a user may choose to provide energy consumption data in order to receive tailored energy offers, participate in an energy community, or support analytical services that optimize system performance. The platform allows users to manage their provided data, review what has been shared, and maintain visibility over how their data is used.

1.4 Consuming Data

Consuming data is the process of accessing and using data that has been made available by other participants in the ecosystem. Users can browse available data offerings, connect to relevant datasets, and download or process the data according to the agreed terms.

This functionality enables users and service providers to build applications, perform analyses, or derive insights based on real and up-to-date information, fostering collaboration and data-driven decision making.

1.5 Offerings and Subscriptions

Data within the platform is shared through offerings. An offering describes a specific dataset, including its purpose, structure, and usage conditions. Users can create offerings for the data they provide and subscribe to offerings created by others.

A subscription represents an active connection between a data consumer and a data offering. Through subscriptions, the platform keeps track of which data exchanges are active and ensures that access is granted only to authorized participants.

1.6 The Role of the Connector

The connector is a core component of the ecosystem. It acts as the technical interface between a participant and the platform, enabling secure communication, data exchange, and policy enforcement.

Through the connector, users can publish data, consume data, configure access rules, and interact with other participants in a standardized way. Although the connector operates behind the scenes, it ensures that all data exchanges comply with security, trust, and interoperability requirements.

Potential users can access the data space either by deploying a local connector at their premises (note: this requires hosting infrastructure, public domain and some relevant expertise) or the connector-as-a-service (CaaS) approach. For the CaaS

1.7 APIs and Integration

The platform provides Application Programming Interfaces (APIs) that allow systems and applications to interact programmatically with the ecosystem. APIs enable users to retrieve lists of offerings, manage subscriptions, upload or download data, and automate interactions without relying solely on the graphical user interface.

This makes the platform suitable not only for manual use, but also for integration with external systems, dashboards, or automated workflows.

2 Main Screen

2.1 Purpose

The Main Screen is the first page displayed after a successful login. It provides a quick overview of your data sharing activity and connector status, serving as the central hub for monitoring your activity and subscriptions.

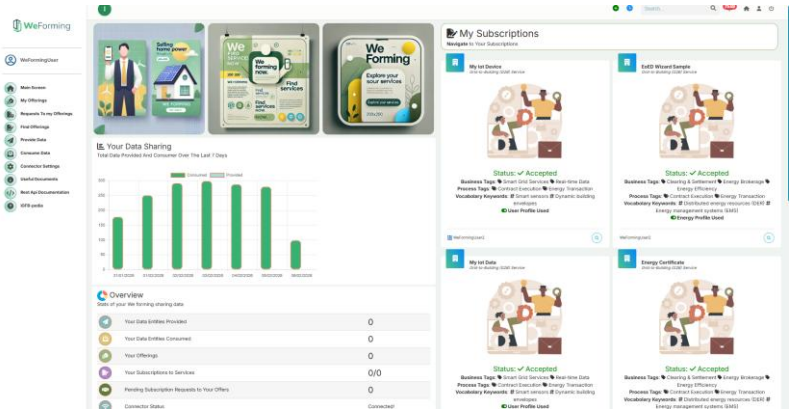


FIGURE 1 WEFORMING MAIN SCREEN

2.2 Data Sharing Chart

- Displays a chart summarizing your data sharing activity over the past week.
- Includes both provided and consumed data.
- Helps visualize trends and patterns in the user's interactions with data.

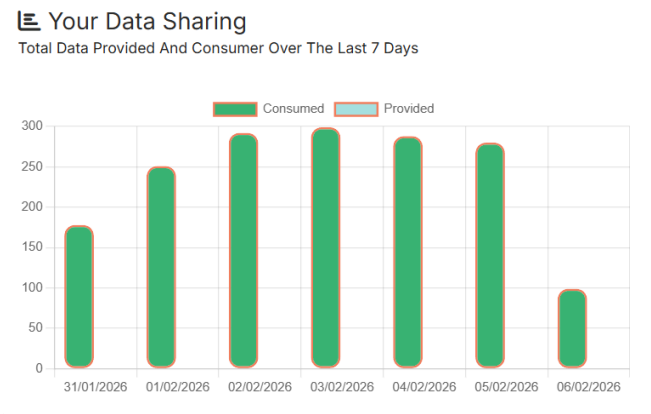


FIGURE 2 DATA SHARING CHART

2.3 Overview Section

The Overview panel provides a numerical summary of the user's data activity and connector status. Each counter displays information in a format appropriate to its content:

Your Data Entities Provided: Shows the total number of data entities provided.

Your Data Entities Consumed: Displays the total number of data entities consumed.

Your Offerings: Indicates the total number of offerings the user currently provides.

Your Subscriptions to Services: Displays the number of services to which the user is currently subscribed.

Pending Subscription Requests to Your Offers: Shows the number of subscription requests to the user's offerings that is awaiting their response.

Connector Status: Displays whether the connector is currently Connected or Disconnected.

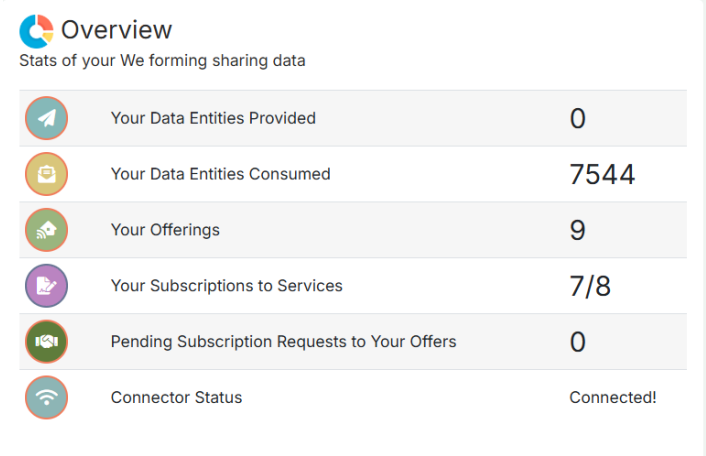


FIGURE 3 MAIN SCREEN – DATA OVERVIEW SECTION

2.4 My Subscriptions

The My Subscriptions panel displays all the services the user is currently subscribed to. To view more details about a specific offering, click the magnifying glass icon next to it. A pop-up window will appear showing comprehensive information about that offering.

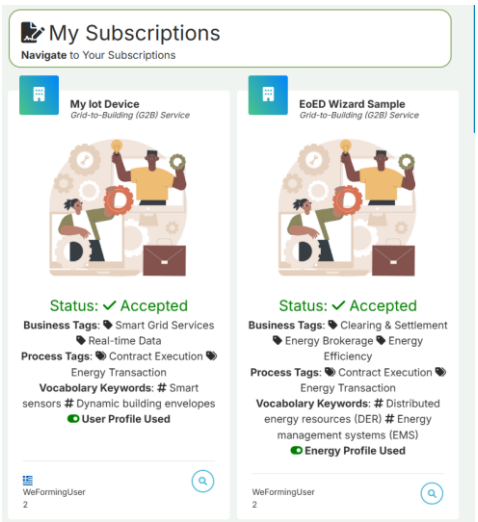


FIGURE 4 MAIN SCREEN – MY SUBSCRIPTIONS SECTION

3 Understanding the User Interface

3.1 Main Navigation (Side Bar)

3.1.1 Purpose

The sidebar provides quick access to the main sections of the platform. It is visible on all pages and allows users to navigate efficiently without returning to the Main Screen.

3.1.2 Menu Items

Main Screen: Returns the user to the dashboard.

My Offerings: Displays all offerings the user has created.

Requests to My Offerings: Shows incoming subscription requests to the user's offerings.

Find Offerings: Allows the user to search and explore offerings provided by other users.

Provide Data: Lets you share the user's data with the platform.

Consume Data: Allows the user to consume data from other users' offerings.

Connector Settings: Configure and monitor the status of their connectors.

Useful Documents: Provides access to guides, manuals, and other documentation.

REST API Documentation: Contains technical information for using the platform API.

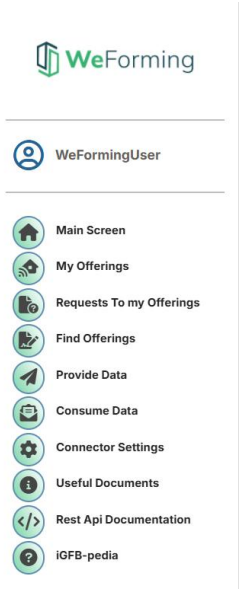


FIGURE 5 SIDE MENU

3.2 Upper Menu

3.2.1 Purpose

The upper menu provides shortcuts, search, notifications, and profile-related actions. It is always visible and complements the sidebar navigation.

FIGURE 6 UPPER MENU

3.2.2 Components

Quick Access Icons: Find Offerings icon: Shortcut to the Find Offerings page. WeForming Data Exchanges Timeline icon: Shortcut to the timeline of the user's data exchanges.

Search Bar: Allows contextual search on the current page only.

Notifications Button: Opens a pop-up displaying the recent notifications.

Home Button: Returns the user to the Main Screen.

Profile Menu: Provides access to the account settings and preferences.

Logout Button: Log out of the platform.

3.2.3 User Tips

- Both the sidebar and upper menu are always visible, allowing users to navigate quickly.
- Icons and buttons often provide shortcuts to the same pages as the sidebar.
- The search bar is page-specific, so results are filtered by the current context.
- Notifications and profile menu are accessible from any page, giving consistent access to updates and settings.

4 Offerings Management

4.1 My Offerings

4.1.1 Purpose

The My Offerings page allows the user to view, manage, and create Service Offerings. From this page, users can filter their offerings, edit any details, or create new ones.

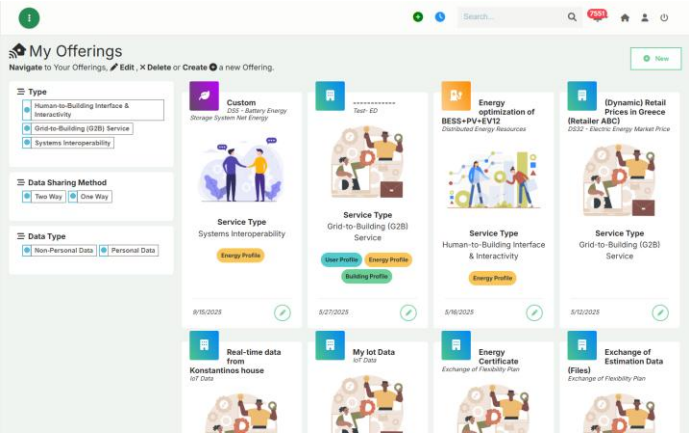


FIGURE 7 MY OFFERINGS SCREEN

4.1.2 Viewing Your Offerings

The page displays a list of all services for which the user have submitted an Offering. Each entry represents a service offering you manage.

Users refine the list using the available filters:

- Type
- Data Sharing Method
- Data Type

These filters help users quickly locate specific offerings based on their characteristics.

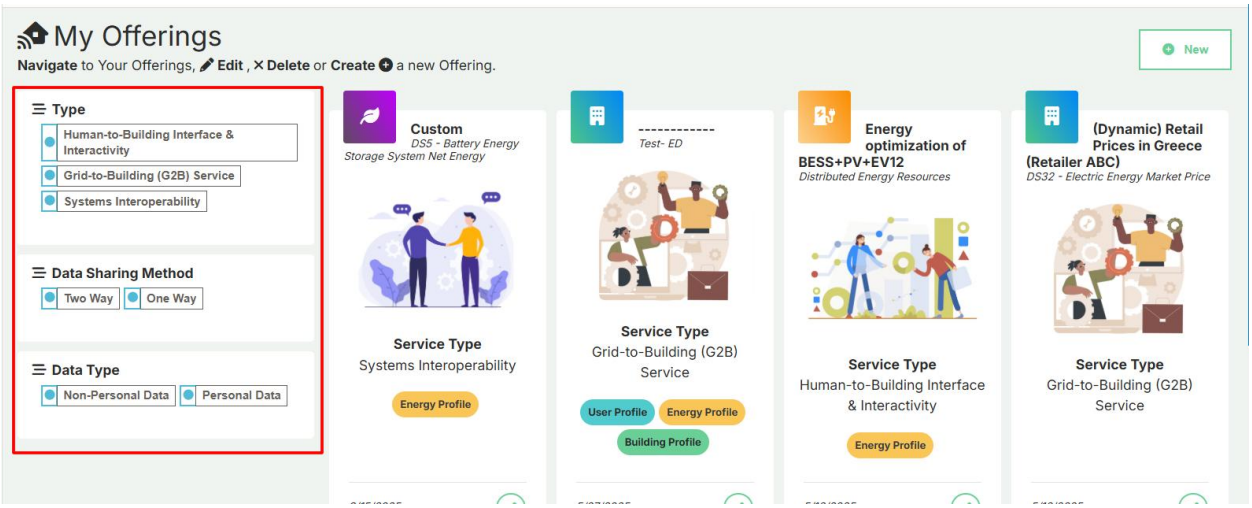


FIGURE 8 MY OFFERINGS FILTERS

4.1.3 Editing an Existing Offering

Each offering includes an edit icon (pencil). Clicking this icon opens the offering configuration page.

The offering configuration page is structured into two main tabs:

- **Service**
- **Semantic Context**

FIGURE 9 OFFERINGS OPEN / EDIT

4.1.3.1 Service Tab

The **Service** tab contains the main configuration menu of the offering. This section includes all functional and descriptive parameters of the service.

Within this tab, users can edit the following sections:

- Service
    - Selecting the *Service* field opens a pop-up displaying the available services.
    - You can choose a different service from the list.
- Base Information

- Profiling
- User Profile
- Energy Profile
- Building Profile

After making changes:

Click **Save** (top-right corner) to store the updates.

Click **Delete** (top-right corner) to remove the offering.

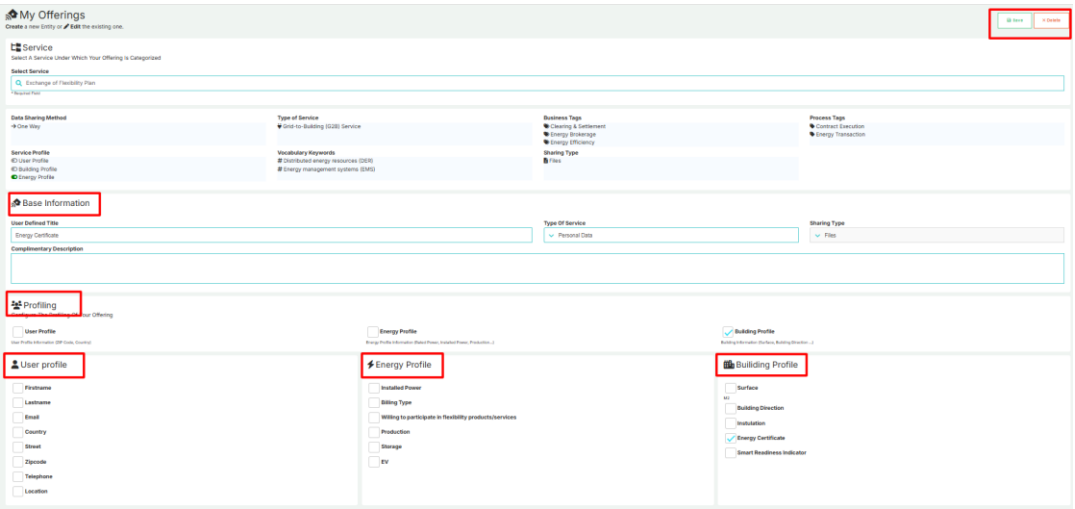


FIGURE 10 OFFERING PAGE AND DETAILS

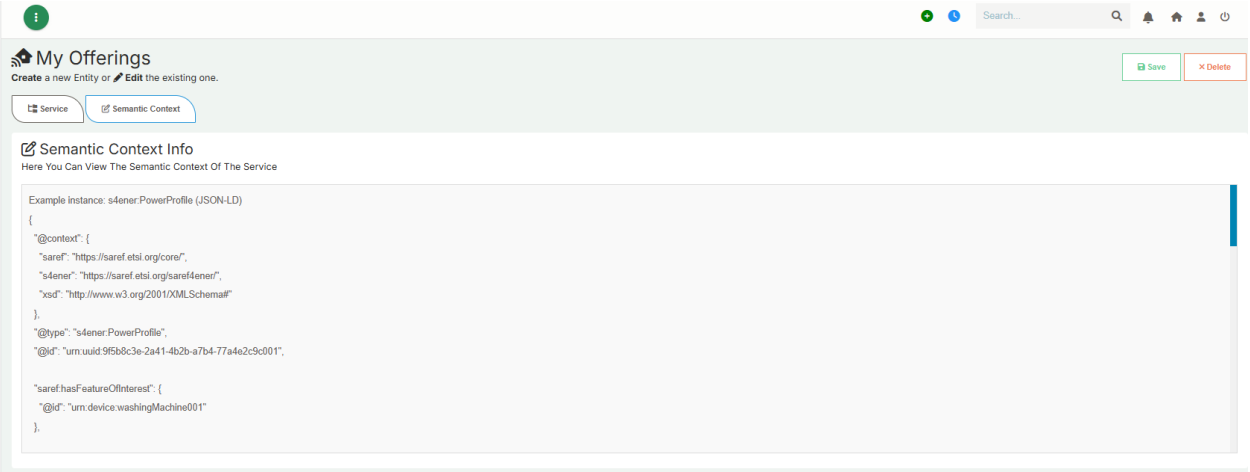
4.1.3.2 Semantic Context Tab

The **Semantic Context** tab provides additional contextual information related to the offering's Identity Hub integration.

This tab includes a text box where the user can view semantic metadata associated with the offering. The displayed information reflects how the offering is represented within the Identity Hub and the broader ecosystem.

This section enhances interoperability and discoverability by ensuring that the offering is semantically described in a standardized way within the platform's data space.

The content in this tab is informational and supports transparency regarding how the offering is identified and structured at the ecosystem level.



4.1.4 Creating a New Offering

To create a new offering, click the New button located at the top-right corner of the My Offerings page.

This action opens the offering configuration interface, which is structured into two main tabs:

- **Service**
- **Semantic Context**

When creating a new offering, all fields in the Service tab are initially empty and must be completed before saving.

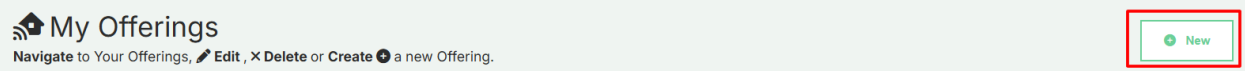


FIGURE 11 OFFERING CREATION BUTTON

The first and mandatory step is to select a Service under which the offering will be categorized.

By clicking on the Select Service field, a pop-up window opens displaying the WeForming Services Catalogue. This catalogue contains the predefined services available within the ecosystem.

The user must choose one service from the catalogue. Once selected, the system automatically associates the offering with that service and pre-fills related attributes such as:

- Data Sharing Method
- Type of Service
- Business Tags
- Process Tags
- Service Profile
- Vocabulary Keywords
- Sharing Type

This ensures that the offering is properly aligned with the standardized structure of the ecosystem.

After selecting the service, the user must complete the Base Information section. This includes:

- **User Defined Title** – A custom name for the offering.

- **Type of Service** – Defines the data classification (e.g., Personal Data).
- **Sharing Type** – Defines how the data will be shared.
- **Complimentary Description** – Additional descriptive information about the offering.

This information helps other participants understand the purpose and context of the offering.

The **Semantic Context** tab provides a view of the semantic metadata associated with the offering.

Once the service is selected and the offering is configured, this tab reflects how the offering is represented within the Identity Hub and the broader ecosystem. It ensures that the offering is semantically described in a structured and interoperable way.

The content in this tab is primarily informational and supports discoverability and standardized identification across the platform.

After completing the required fields:

- Click **Save** (top-right corner) to create the new offering.
- Click **Delete** to discard the configuration.

Once saved, the offering becomes visible in the My Offerings list and can be managed, edited, or shared within the ecosystem.

4.1.5 User Actions on the My Offerings Page

- Filter offerings by type, data sharing method, or data type.
- Edit existing offerings and update their configuration.
- Create new Offerings from scratch.
- Save changes or delete offerings as needed.

4.2 Requests to My Offerings

4.2.1 Purpose

The **Requests to My Offerings** page allows users to review and manage incoming subscription requests from other users who wish to access their offerings.

4.2.2 Viewing Incoming Requests

The page displays a list of all incoming requests related to the user's offerings. Each request includes basic information, such as the **Request Status** and the **User Requesting**

To help manage large numbers of requests, users can apply filters based on:

- Status
- Requesting User's Company
- Requesting User
- Type

These filters allow users to quickly locate and prioritize specific requests.

4.2.3 Accepting or Rejecting Requests

Each request includes an **edit icon (pencil)**. Clicking this icon opens the offering request page, where the user can view all detailed information related to the request and the associated offering.

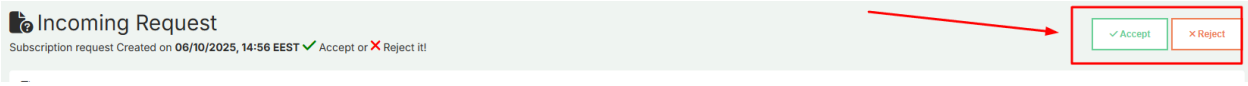
On the request details page, you can act on the incoming request:

Click **Accept** to approve the request if the status is *Pending*.

Click **Reject** to decline the request.

Both actions are available via buttons located in the **top-right corner** of the page.

When the Offering is *Accepted* the Accept button is locked and the user can only decline the Offering.



5 Discovering & Using Offerings

5.1 Find Offerings

5.1.1 Purpose

The **Find Offerings** page allows users to browse and discover all available offerings provided by other users. From this page, they can search, filter, review offering details, and submit subscription requests.

5.1.2 Browsing Available Offerings

The page displays a list of all available offerings on the platform.

Users refine the displayed results using the available filters:

- Type
- Providers & Offerings

These filters help narrow down the offerings based on their interests and requirements.

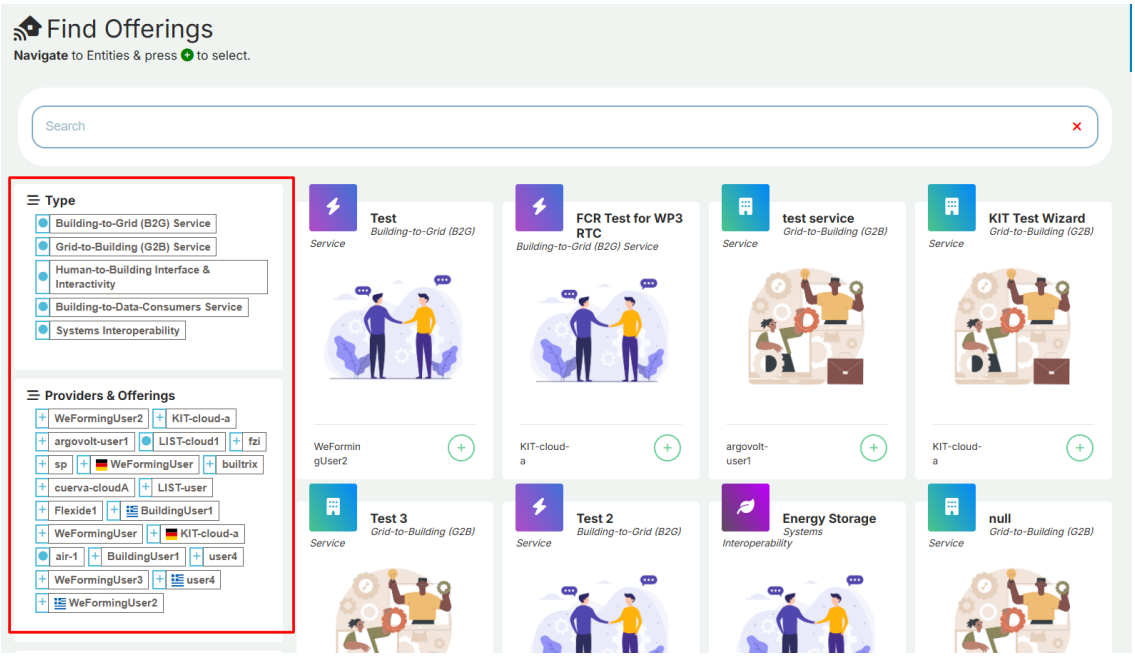


FIGURE 12 FIND OFFERINGS PAGE & FILTERS

5.1.3 Searching for Offerings

In addition to filters, the user can use the search bar to find specific offerings. The search functionality supports:

- Offering names
- Tags
- Vocabulary keywords

This allows more flexible and precise discovery of offerings.

Each Offering includes a **plus (+) icon**. Clicking this icon opens a pop-up window displaying detailed information about the selected offering.

The pop-up includes:

- Complete offering details
- A text field where you can add comments for the provider from whom you are requesting the Offering

Within the offering details pop-up:

- Click **Make Request** to submit your request for the offering.
- Alternatively, close the pop-up without submitting a request if you do not wish to proceed.

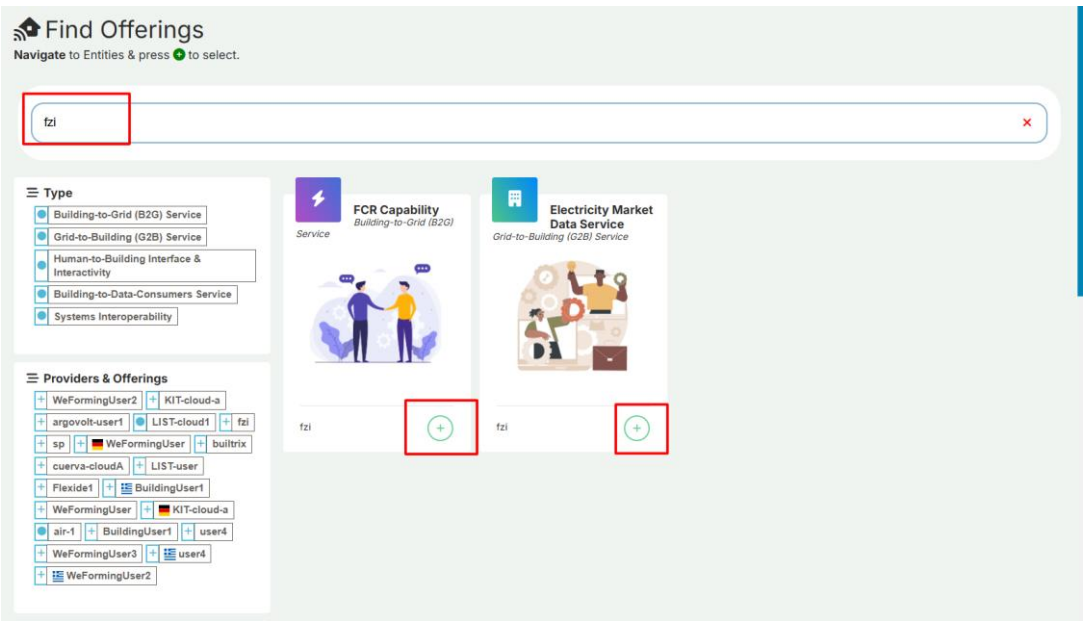


FIGURE 13 FIND OFFERINGS SEARCH AND OPEN BUTTON

5.1.4 User Actions on the Find Offerings Page

- Browse all available offerings.
- Filter offerings by type, provider, or offering name.
- Search offerings using names, tags, or vocabulary keywords.
- View detailed offering information.
- Submit or cancel subscription requests.

5.2 Consume Data

The **Consume Data** section provides users with access to all data offerings to which they are currently subscribed. Upon entering this page, the user is presented with a list of connected offerings, representing the services that they are consuming from other providers within the platform.

To support efficient navigation, the list can be filtered using multiple criteria, including:

- the **data provider**,

- the **type of offering**, and
- the **period** during which the subscription or data exchange took place.

Each offering in the list includes quick-action options. By selecting the blue cloud icon, the user can directly download the available dataset without navigating away from the list view. Alternatively, clicking the green magnifying glass icon redirects the user to the detailed view of the selected offering. This page displays all relevant information related to the offering, including its metadata and subscription details. From this view, the dataset can be downloaded by selecting the **Download** button located in the upper-right corner of the page.

Through this section, users can easily monitor, explore, and retrieve the data they consume, ensuring transparency and convenient access to shared datasets across the platform.

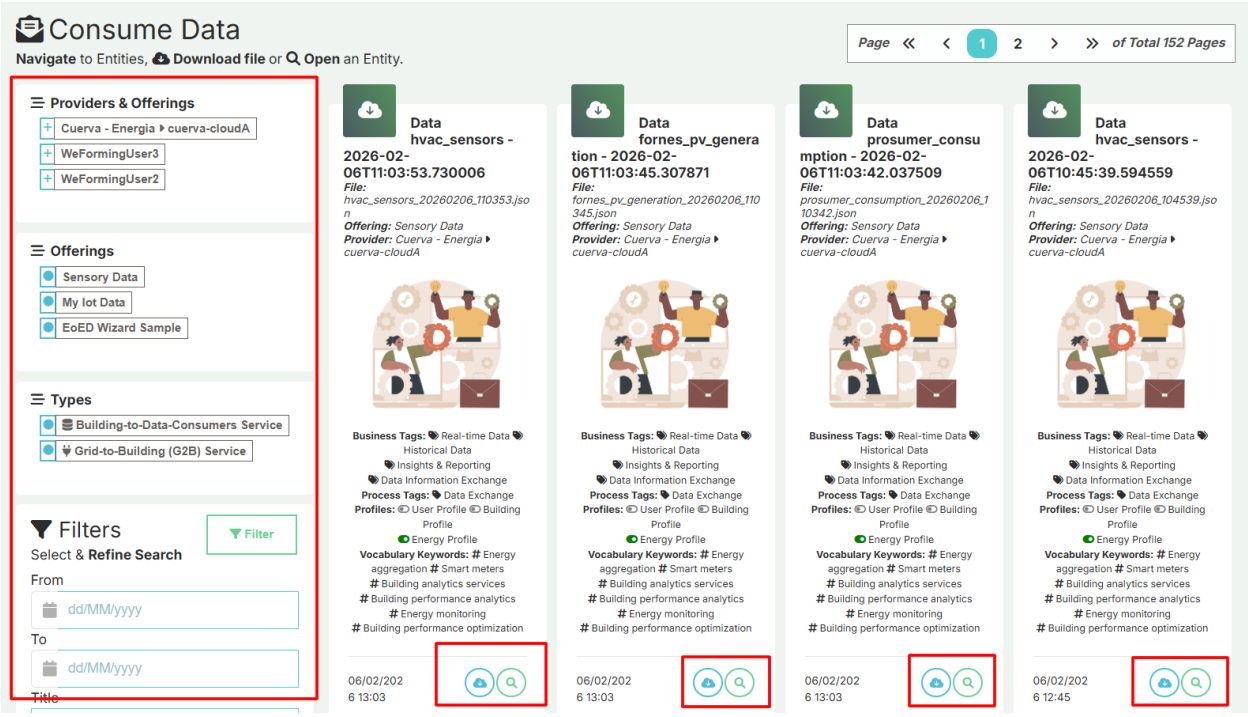


FIGURE 14 CONSUME DATA PAGE

6 Data Provision & Sharing

6.1 Provide Data

The **Provide Data** section enables users to manage the datasets they share through the platform. When accessing this page, the user is presented with a list of all previously provided data entries, each associated with a specific offering. To facilitate navigation and quick access, the list supports searching and filtering based on available fields such as **ID**, **Title**, and other relevant attributes.

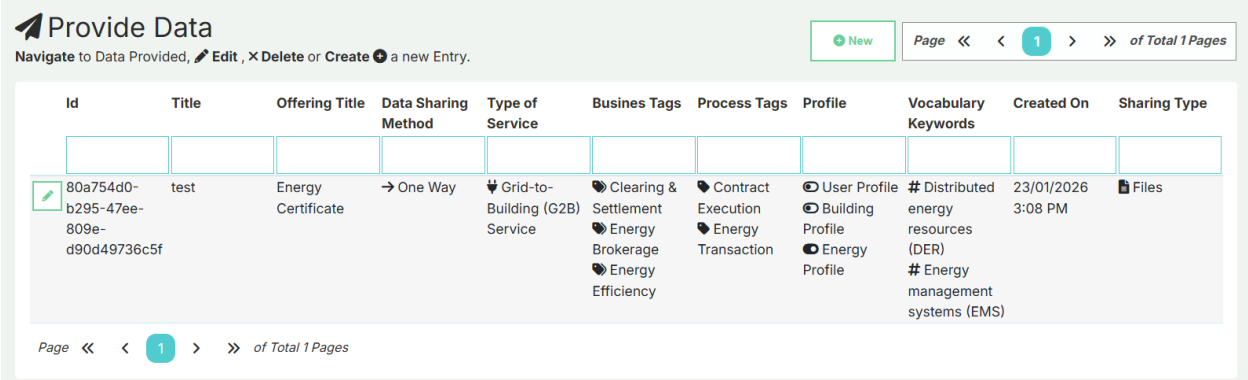


FIGURE 15 PROVIDED DATA EXAMPLE

Selecting the pencil icon located on the left side of each entry redirects the user to the detailed view of the corresponding data provision. This page presents all associated metadata and information related to the selected offering. At the bottom of the page, the user can download the shared dataset by selecting the **Download File** button. If the data provision is no longer needed, it can be permanently removed using the **Delete** button available in the upper-right corner of the page.

To create a new data provision, the user returns to the main Provide Data view and selects the **New** button. The creation process consists of the following steps:

- Defining a title and description for the dataset.
- Selecting one of the available offerings from the My Offerings list.
- Automatically populating the associated tags based on the selected offering.
- Uploading the data file to be shared.

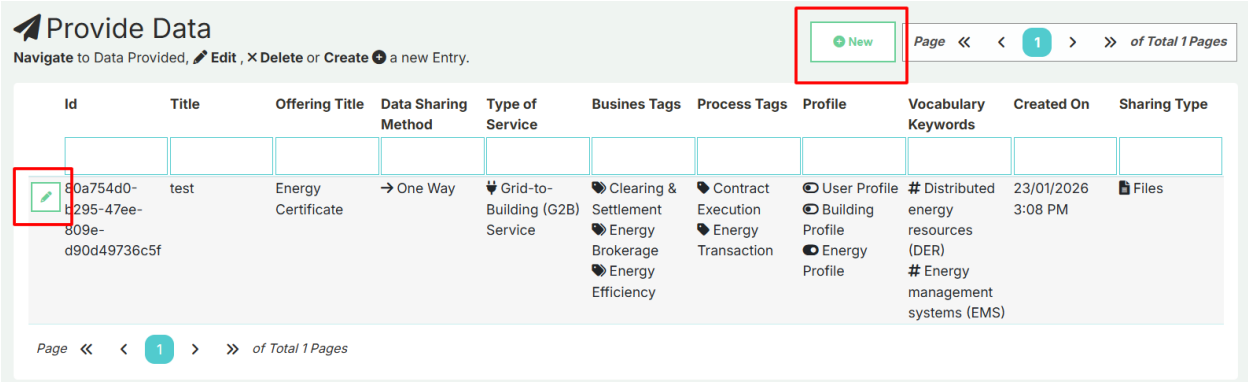


FIGURE 16 CREATE NEW & EDIT PROVIDED DATA

Once all required information has been provided, the user completes the process by selecting the **Save** button located in the upper-right corner of the page. Alternatively, the **Delete** option allows the user to discard the data provision if necessary.

For users with programming expertise, periodic data uploads can also be automated using Python scripts, enabling scheduled and systematic data provision without manual interaction.

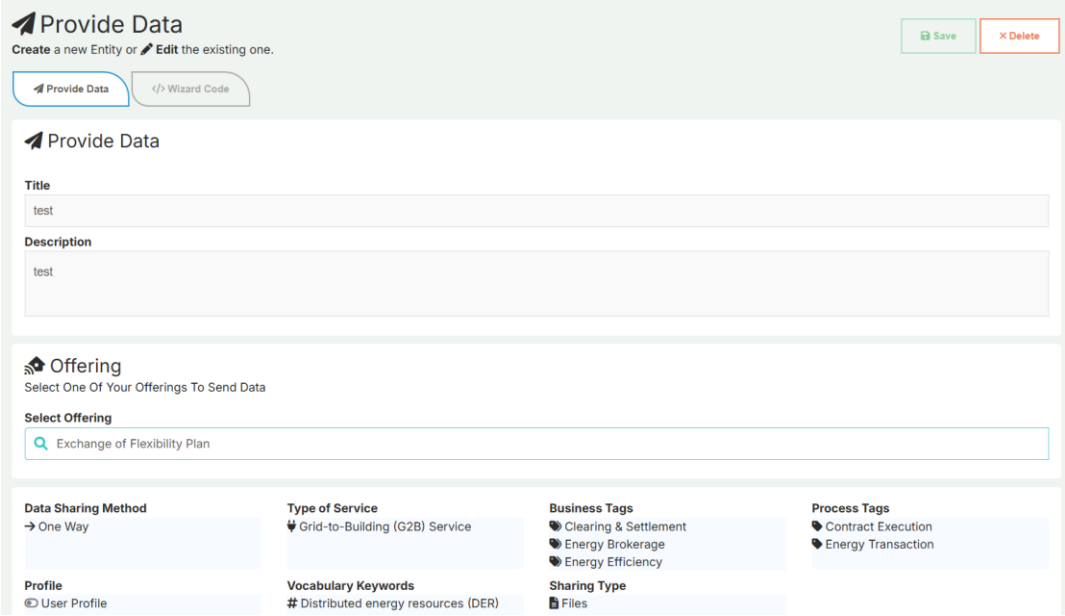


FIGURE 17 PROVIDED DATA EXAMPLE

6.2 WeForming Data Exchanges Timeline

The WeForming Data Exchanges Timeline offers a chronological view of all data exchange activities performed within the platform. The user can access this page by selecting the blue clock icon located in the upper menu.

FIGURE 18 WEFORMING DATA EXCHANGES TIMELINE IN UPPER MENU

Once on the timeline page, the user can:

- View all data exchanges ordered from the **most recent** to the **oldest**.

- Distinguish the direction of data exchange through the two-column layout:
  - The **left column** displays datasets that the user has **provided**,
  - The **right column** displays datasets that the user has **consumed**.

For each data exchange entry, the following actions are available:

- Selecting **Open** opens the corresponding offering in a **new browser tab**.
- Reviewing the offering details directly from the linked page.

To further refine the information displayed, the user can apply **date range filters** to view data exchanges within a specific time period.

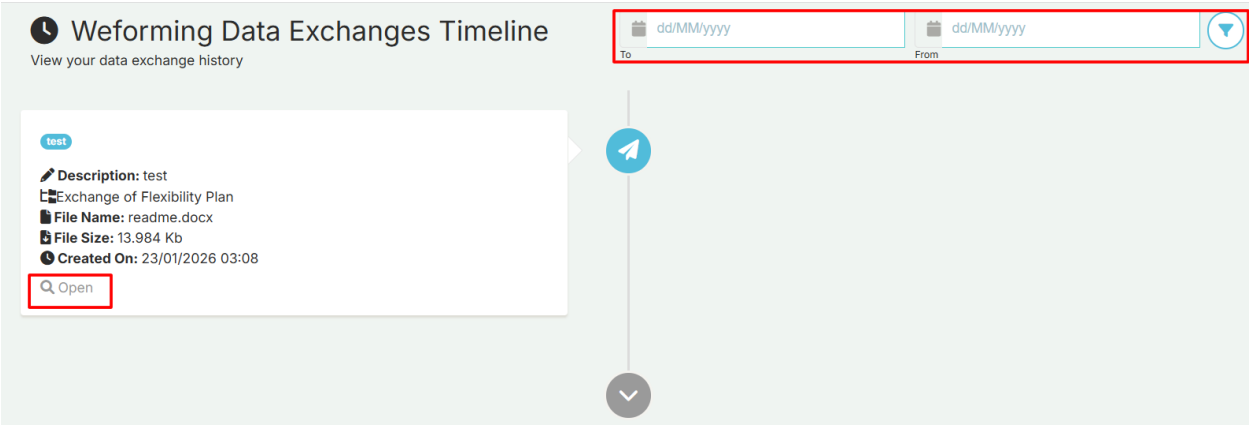


FIGURE 19 WEFORMING DATA EXCHANGES TIMELINE EXAMPLE

This timeline provides a clear and transparent overview of data-sharing activities, enabling users to monitor, verify, and revisit their data exchange history within the WeForming ecosystem.

7 Technical Configuration

7.1 Connector Settings

Connector Settings is accessible from the main navigation menu and is organized into two tabs: **Settings** and **Your Consumers**.

Settings

When accessing **Connector Settings** from the main menu, the user is initially directed to the **Settings** page. This page represents the core configuration area of the user's connector and provides an overview of both user-related and connector-related information.

At the top of the page, the user can view their **personal details**, which are displayed for reference purposes. These include the user's unique identifier (ID), email address, username, and associated company. This information helps clearly identify the connector owner within the WeForming ecosystem.

FIGURE 20 USER INFORMATION

Below this section, the page focuses on the **connector connection configuration**. At this point, the user is required to define how their connector will be connected to the platform. Two alternative options are supported.

In the first option, the user may choose to **connect their own connector**. In this case, the user is asked to manually provide the required technical endpoints and identifiers. These include:

- Handler URL
- Handler Public URL
- Connector Public URL
- Connector Management URL
- Connector Protocol URL
- Connector Control URL
- Connector DID

These fields describe how the connector can be reached, managed, and identified within the data space, enabling secure communication and data exchange with other participants.

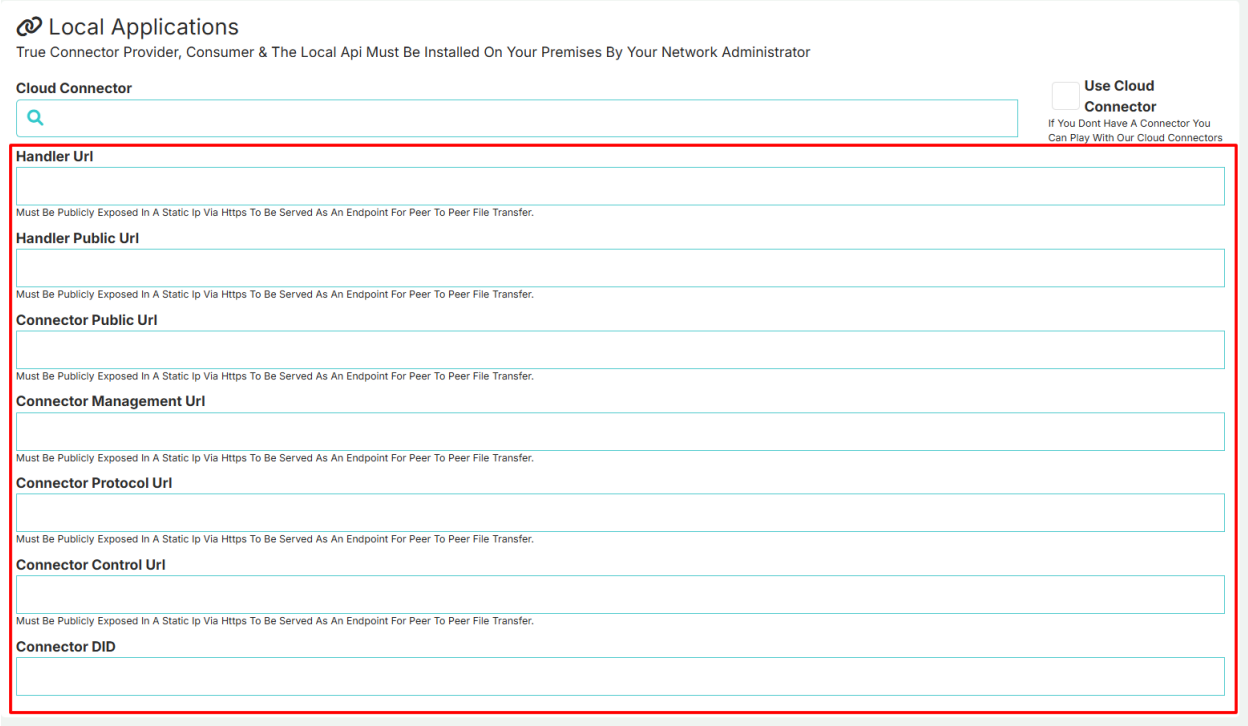


FIGURE 21 CONNECTOR CREDENTIALS

Alternatively, the user may opt to **use a pre-configured cloud connector**. This option is intended for users who do not operate their own connector infrastructure. The connection to a cloud connector, however, cannot be completed directly through the application interface. Instead, the user must submit a request to the platform's administrative team. Once approved, the administrators will associate the user with an available cloud connector and complete the setup on their behalf.

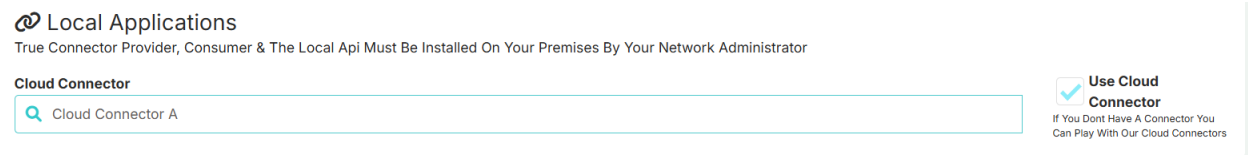


FIGURE 22 CLOUD CONNECTOR

Your Consumers

The **Your Consumers** tab provides an overview of the participants that consume data through the user's connector. This page displays a list of active data consumers and helps users maintain visibility and control over their data-sharing relationships.

The information is presented in a table format and includes:

- **Company**: The organization consuming the data.
- **Username**: The user associated with the data consumption.
- **Data App URL**: The endpoint used by the consumer to access the data.
- **ECC URL**: The endpoint of the consumer's data space connector.

If no consumers are currently connected, the list appears empty, indicating that no active data consumption relationships are ongoing.

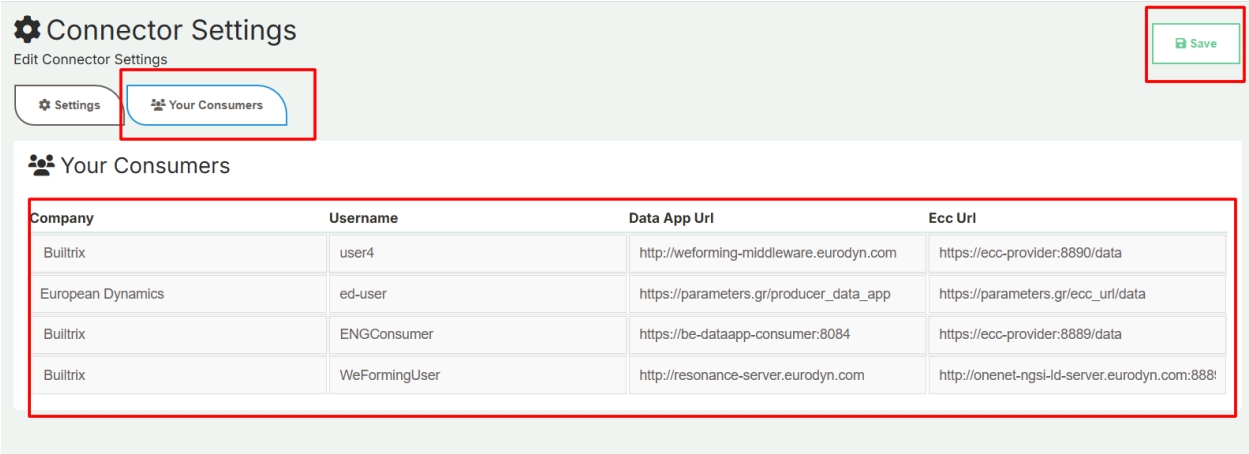


FIGURE 23 YOUR CONSUMERS EXAMPLE

7.2 REST API Documentation

The **REST API Documentation** section provides an interactive interface for exploring and using the WeForming platform APIs. This page is primarily intended for developers and advanced users who wish to access platform functionalities programmatically or integrate external systems with the WeForming middleware.

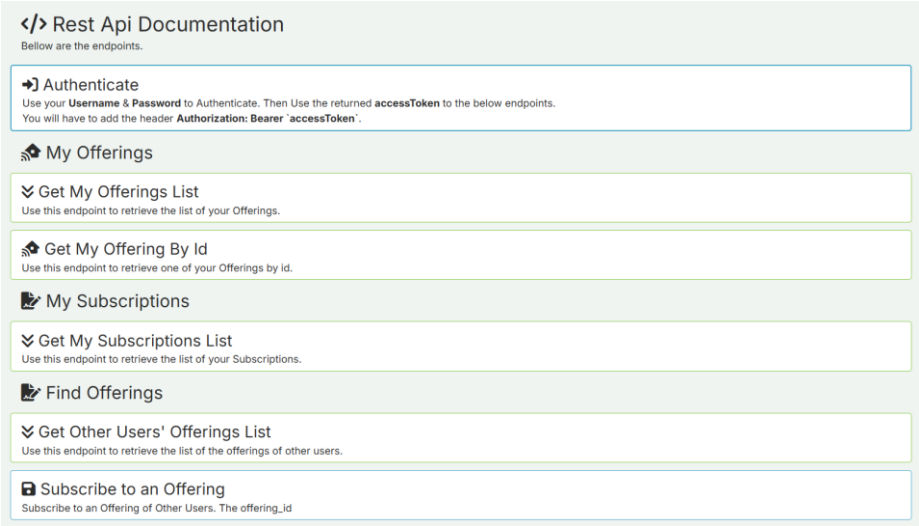


FIGURE 24 REST API PAGE

The available APIs are organized into functional categories, such as **My Offerings**, **My Subscriptions**, and **Find Offerings**. Each category contains a list of expandable endpoints, allowing users to easily browse and select the operation they are interested in. For every endpoint, the interface displays the HTTP method (GET or POST), the endpoint URL, and a results panel where the response is shown.

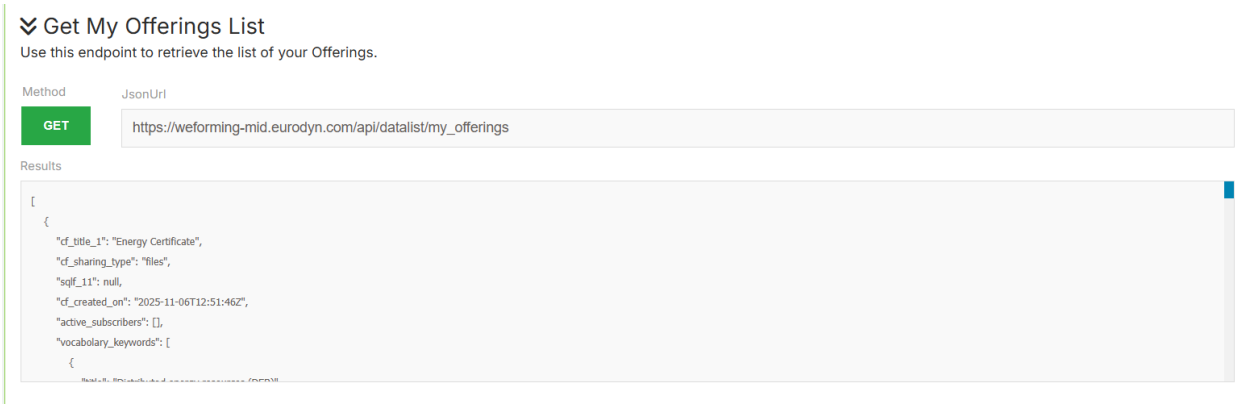


FIGURE 25 MY OFFERINGS API EXAMPLE

Users can interact with the API directly from this page by expanding an endpoint and executing the request. The returned data are displayed in the results section, enabling users to inspect responses in real time and verify the structure and content of the exchanged information. This interactive approach supports testing, debugging, and understanding how platform services can be accessed programmatically.

Through the REST API Documentation, users can:

- Retrieve information about their **offerings and subscriptions**.
- Discover available offerings via dedicated search endpoints.
- Programmatically access platform services using **standard RESTful methods**.

This section complements the graphical user interface by enabling automated access to WeForming functionalities and supporting advanced integration scenarios with external applications and systems.

8 Documentation & Support

Useful Documents

The **Useful Documents** section provides access to supporting documentation and knowledge resources related to the WeForming platform and Intelligent Grid-Forming Buildings (iGFBs). This section can be accessed directly from the main navigation menu and is designed to support users with both conceptual and practical guidance.

FIGURE 26 USEFUL DOCUMENTS

Within this section, users can choose among the following options:

- Navigate through *i-GFB pedia* online.
- Download the *User Manual*.
- Download the *Deployment Guide & Installation Manual*.

8.1 Notifications

The **Notifications** feature provides users with a quick way to stay informed about data exchanges within the WeForming ecosystem. By clicking the **Notifications icon** in the upper menu, a pop-up panel opens, displaying a chronological list of data that has been provided to the user.

Each notification represents a completed or available data provision. The most recent notifications appear at the top of the list, allowing users to immediately identify new incoming data without navigating through multiple pages.

When a user selects (opens) a notification, they are automatically redirected to the corresponding offering page, where all related details are available. Once opened, the notification is removed from the list, ensuring that the panel only displays pending or unseen items and remains clean and easy to follow.

Through this mechanism, notifications act as an entry point to newly shared data, helping users seamlessly transition from awareness to action, while maintaining a clear overview of data activity within the platform.

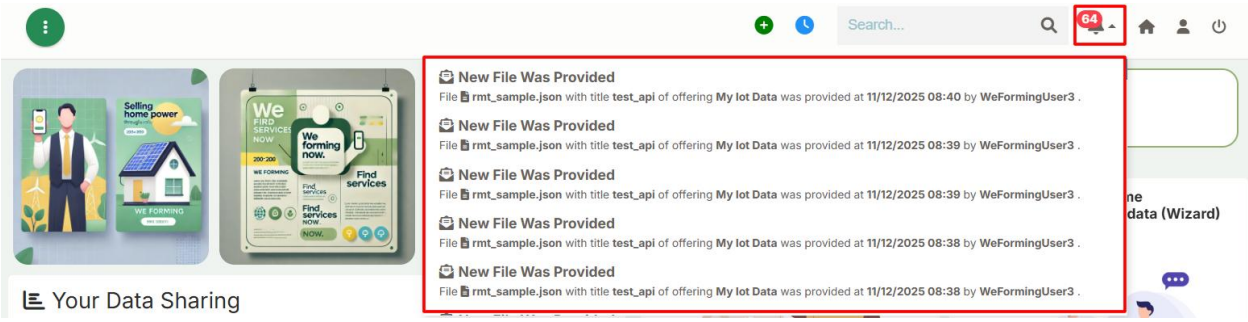


FIGURE 27 NOTIFICATIONS EXAMPLE

9 Profile & Account Management

9.1 Purpose

The **Profile** section allows you to manage your personal information, energy-related data, and building details. It is used to maintain accurate profile information that supports platform services and interactions.

The Profile section is accessed from the **upper menu** by selecting **Profile**. Once opened, the profile is organized into three categories.

9.2 User Profile

The **User Profile** page contains your personal account information. Here, you can view, add, or edit your personal details. If any fields are empty, you may complete them at any time.

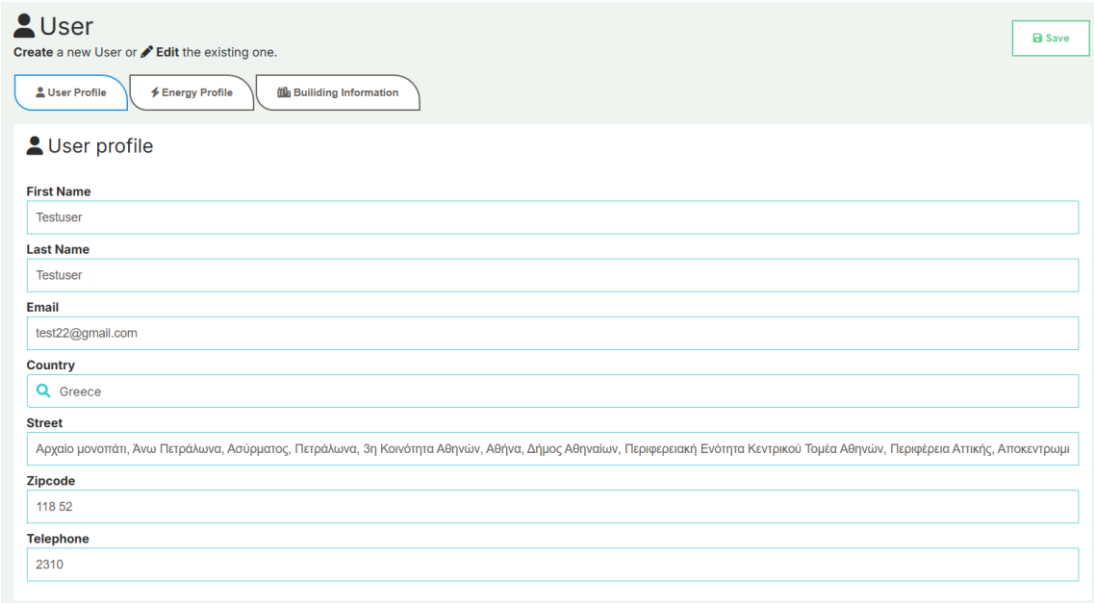


FIGURE 28 USER PROFILE PAGE

From this section, the user can also change your account password, allowing you to manage your login credentials and maintain account security.

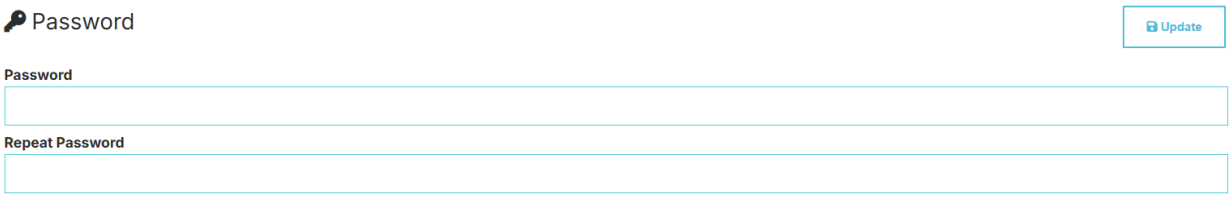


FIGURE 29 CHANGE PASSWORD

9.3 Energy Profile

The Energy Profile section defines the user's role on the platform and determines the type of information users are required to provide.

9.3.1 Initial Setup

When a new user enters the Energy Profile for the first time, a dropdown list is displayed. From this list, they must select the type of user they are.

This selection:

- Is required during the initial setup
- **Cannot be changed later**
- Is no longer displayed once it has been completed
- After the selection is saved, the corresponding Energy Profile view is shown automatically in future visits.

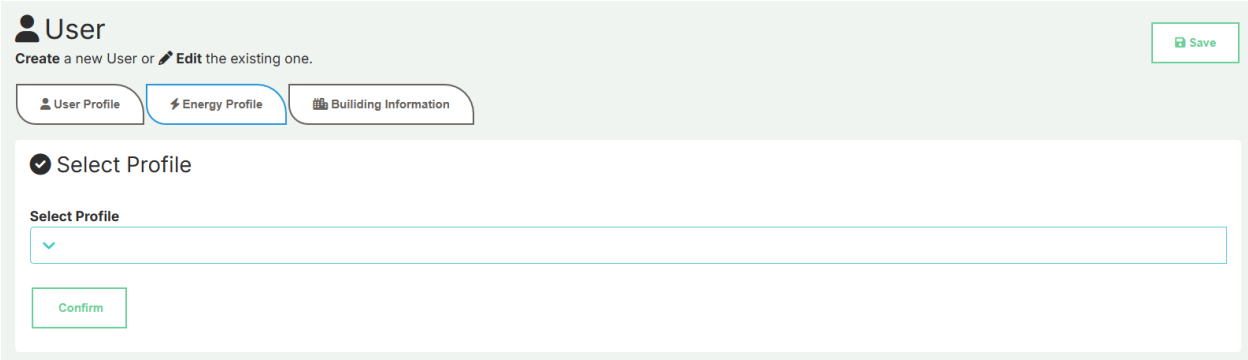


FIGURE 30 PROFILE / TYPE OF USER

9.3.2 Building User

If the user select **Building User**, the Energy Profile displays all applicable measurement categories that may exist in a household, such as:

- Photovoltaic systems
- EV chargers
- Other energy-related assets and measurements

In this view, users can:

- Declare their available measurements
- Enter consumption or production data where applicable
- All changes can be saved by clicking the **Save** button located in the **top-right corner** of the page.

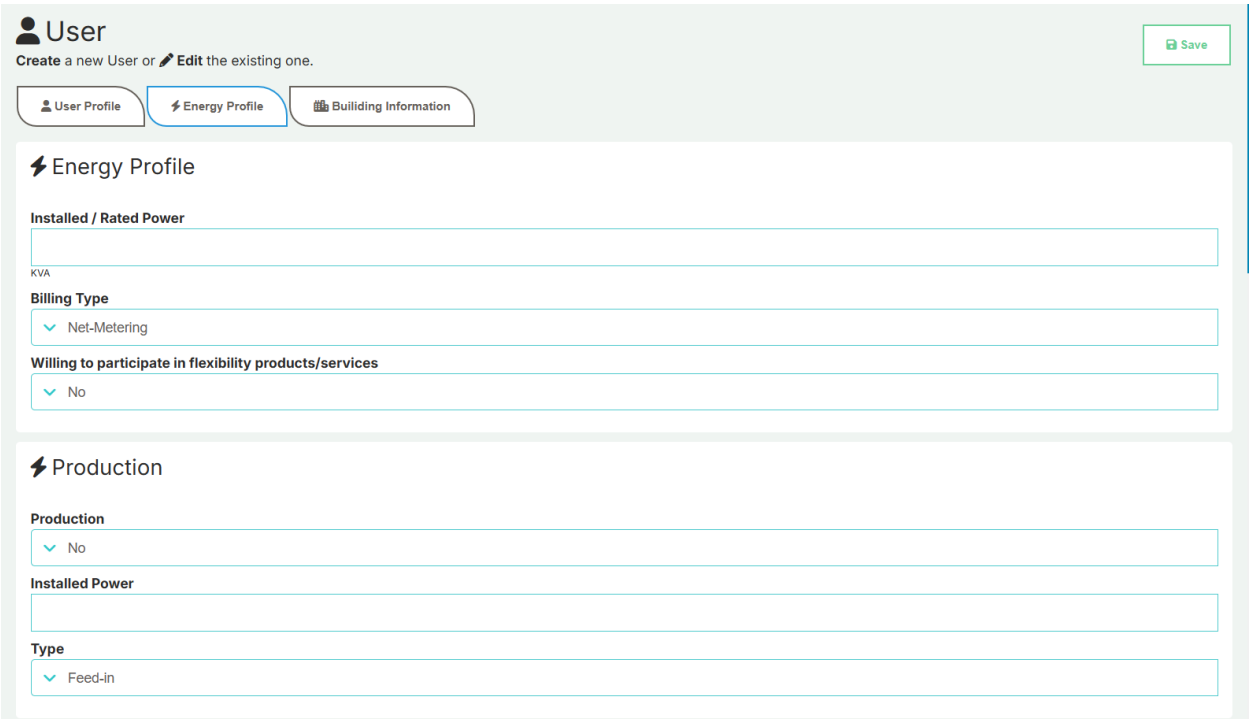


FIGURE 31 BUILDING USER PAGE

9.3.3 Other User Roles (Administrative Roles)

If they select any other user role, this indicates an administrative or management role.

In this case, the Energy Profile displays an open text field, where users can describe:

- Their role
- Their responsibilities
- Any additional information they consider relevant

After entering or updating the information, click Save (top-right corner) to store any changes.

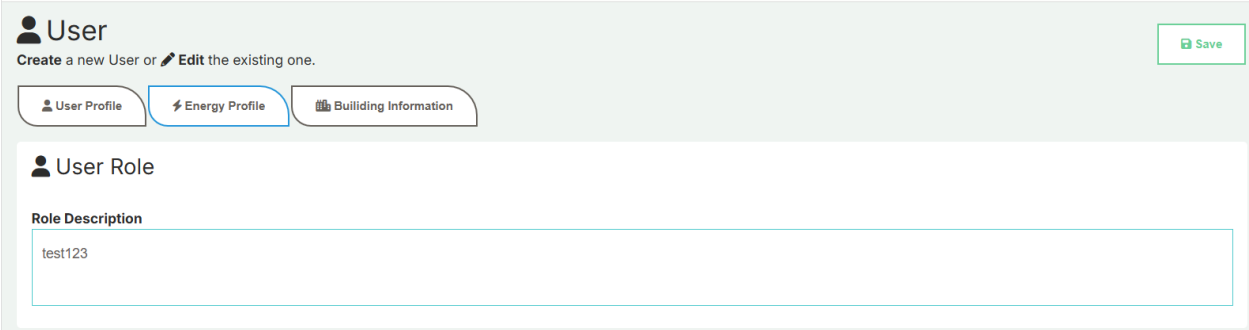


FIGURE 32 OTHER USER ROLES PROFILE

9.4 Building Information

The **Building Information** section allows users to enter and manage details related to their household or building.

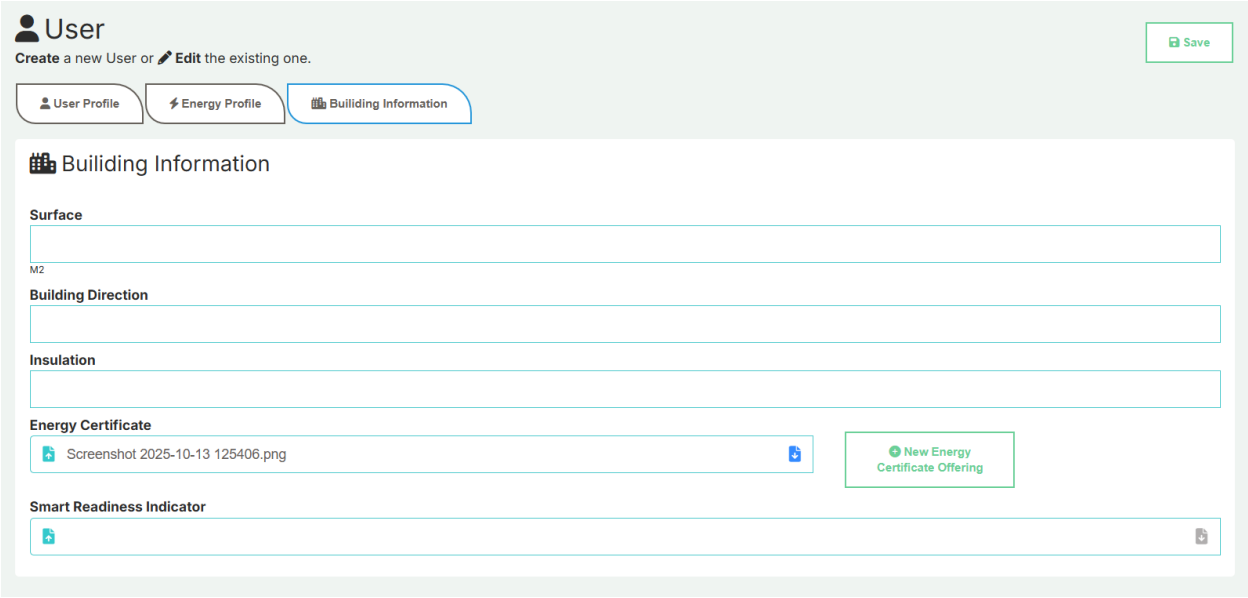


FIGURE 33 BUILDING INFORMATION PAGE

In this section, they can add or edit the following information:

- **Household area** (building size)
- **Building direction**
- **Insulation** details

If the information has already been provided, it can be reviewed and updated at any time.

After completing or updating the building information and uploading the required documents, click the **Save** button to store your changes.

9.4.1 Document Uploads

The Building Information section also allows users to upload two supporting documents:

- **Energy Performance Certificate**
- **Smart Readiness Indicator (SRI)** document

These documents are used to support and validate the building-related information provided.

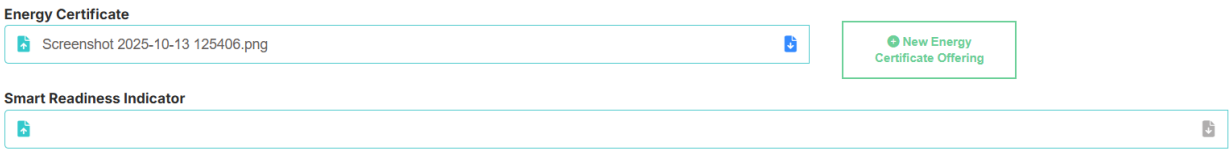


FIGURE 34 DOCUMENTS UPLOAD